



PAKISTAN IS YET TO TAKE CONCRETE ACTION AGAINST HAFIZ SAEED

and mark my words, this is the question we will be debating 10 years down the line. This country and this Government are incapable of dealing with an obstinate Pakistan and taking strategic leap in terms of trust. I am afraid we have neither shown a will nor a strategic vision to deal with Pakistan. There are at least 20 different military options and waging war or a military strike is only one extreme. The question we need to ask ourselves is that post-26/11, what have we done? Did we recall our high commissioner? Did we symbolically take the smallest of small steps, for example, suspending the composite dialogue process officially? The answer is no. Can anybody tell me what action have we taken of any kind, including the symbolic type?

G. Parthasarathy: The circumstances surrounding 26/11 and the killing of foreigners in front of an international television audience exposed the Pakistanis and showed what they really are. There was no getting away from it. This created circumstances on which international pressure on Pakistan grew. I think the way we played it in capitals that mattered was good. Our capacity to influence the ISI or the army is limited. And in my opinion, the ability to bring about international pressure was exercised well. To say that nothing happened, therefore, is not correct. An atmosphere was created, perhaps the events themselves were responsible, and India gained some leverage. I agree that the

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Pakistan should be made to realise that it will have to pay a price for terrorist acts, not just a diplomatic price, but also a price otherwise.

Covert and overt actions need to be essential ingredients of India's policy. India must exploit faultlines within Pakistan.

Pursue a policy of selective engagement with Pakistan on terrorism, but put composite dialogue into cold storage.

We have failed to take up the issues of terrorism strongly enough at the official level.

Pakistan has problems in Afghanistan as well as Iran. These are options we need to work on.